B2B marketers are losing the *AI ROI race.*

371 senior marketing leaders across the US, UK, Europe and APAC told us why — and how to fix it.

THE GAP

B2B vs B2C.
Same technology.
Very different results.

B2B

5%
exceeding AI ROI expectations

52%
report limited ROI

20%
have seen no ROI at all

VS

B2C / HYBRID

31%
exceeding expectations

34%
reporting clear returns

80%

of B2B organisations admit they're not ready — or only somewhat prepared — to rebuild workflows around human-AI collaboration.

They're layering AI onto legacy processes and calling it transformation.

THE WINNERS

Organisations that redesign workflows outperform by a factor of 3.

73%

"Power Partners" report clear or exceeding AI ROI

22%

productivity-layer-only orgs report the same

66%

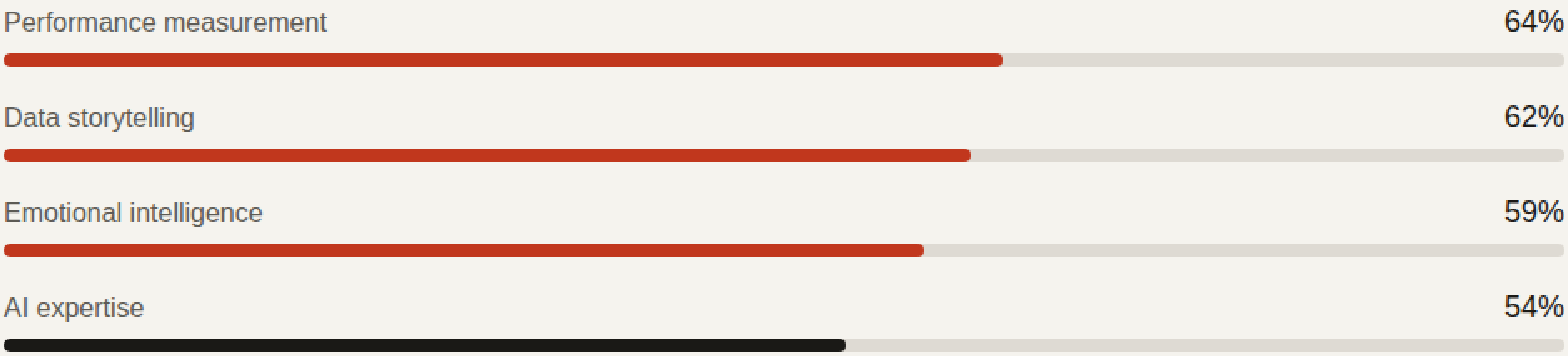
say AI collaboration has a major impact on creativity

20%

is the ceiling when AI is just a productivity layer

THE HUMAN EDGE

The top skill in 2026 isn't AI expertise. It's this.



AI handles execution. Humans own meaning, context, and commercial judgement.

TRUST & GOVERNANCE

Only 48% of marketing orgs have AI ethics guidelines. The real safeguard isn't policy.

67%	Ensuring ethical use of data
63%	Maintaining brand voice as automation drifts
62%	Championing long-term trust over short-term gains
61%	Human input in training AI

AI governance protects the company. Human marketers protect the relationship.

REINVESTMENT

When AI creates efficiency, the best leaders don't pocket the gains.

70% Reinvesting into innovation and future growth

58% Investing in personalisation and customer experience

56% Upskilling their teams

This isn't about doing more with less. It's about doing better with more.

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Marketers create value on the questions AI can't answer: intent, relevance, and commercial impact.

Maria Samoilescu — former Director of Brand Content Strategy, Prudential Financial

Free report — link in comments

Return on AI is an operating model challenge. Not a technology one.

Download the full research from WongDoody × CMO Council. 371 leaders. Real numbers. A clear path forward.